

EDITOR'S NOTE



FROM JOHANNESBURG TO THE WORLD: THE GLOBAL SOUTH TAKES THE STAGE

Welcome to the launch issue of *BRICS & The Global South* – a magazine born out of a shared belief that the world's next great stories of growth, innovation, and resilience are being written across the Global South.

This inaugural edition arrives at a pivotal moment: as BRICS expands, the G20 redefines global governance, and developing nations increasingly shape the agenda for sustainable, inclusive progress. Fittingly, this year's G20 Summit takes place in Johannesburg, South Africa, under the theme "Solidarity, Equality and Sustainability" – a timely reminder that our collective future depends on cooperation across borders, sectors, and generations.

The Global South is no longer a peripheral actor – it's a driver of transformation, from Africa's green minerals and smart cities to Asia's manufacturing prowess and Latin America's clean energy revolution.

In many ways, the magazine itself is a reflection of this interconnected, globalised world. Our editorial, creative and sales teams span cities and continents – from London to Cape Town and Johannesburg – collaborating across borders to bring these stories to life. That, in essence, is what this publication stands for: partnership, perspective, and a shared vision for the future.

This issue explores how collaboration and creativity are reshaping the global order. We begin with reflections on the shared future of BRICS nations, followed by features on inclusive development in Africa, digital and skills transformation, and food security in the Global South. Our deep dive into artificial intelligence and cybersecurity examines how emerging technologies can empower rather than exclude. We also turn our attention to the evolving G20-BRICS dynamic, prospects for a BRICS currency, and the role of the New Development Bank in creating a truly multipolar financial system.

Beyond policy, this magazine is about people – innovators, thinkers, and young leaders who are redefining what it means to build from the South and for the South. You'll find interviews and insights from voices leading this change, including a feature on developing the next generation of African leaders.

A special thank you to the BRICS+ Consulting Group – Cole Jackson, Chloé Maluleke, and Sesona Mdlokovana – for their tireless work and creativity in bringing this publication to life. I often joke that the "+" in BRICS+ represents the many hats they wear, which now officially includes producing a magazine. Their commitment, energy, and belief in the power of collective storytelling have made this possible.

BRICS & The Global South is more than a publication – it's a platform for ideas that matter, and for connections that move us toward a fairer, more balanced world.

Thank you for joining us on this journey. The future is multipolar, and it starts here.

Saarah Survé,
Editor-in-Chief